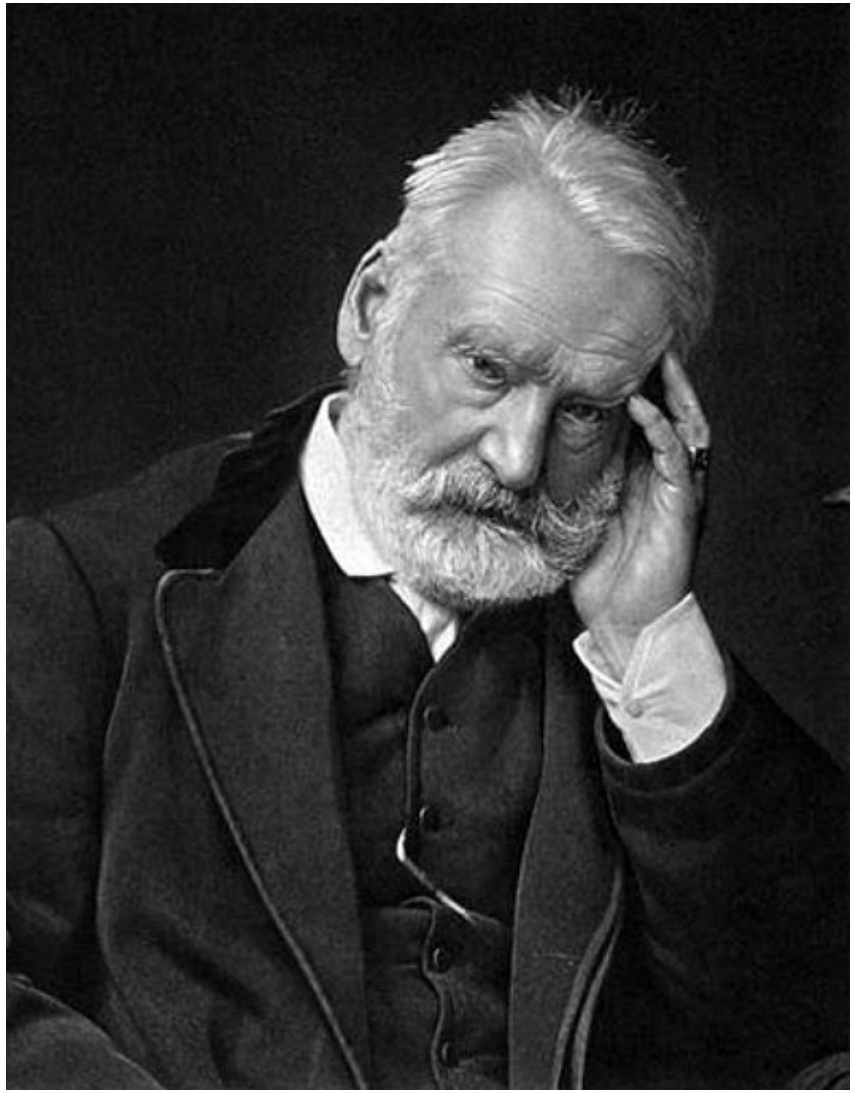
Ch. 2: The Evolution of the European Union.



Francisco de Goya: The Dance (1777).

Early Visions of a United Europe.



Victor Hugo,
French Poet, 1802-1885

The idea of uniting Europe came up in the 19th century:

Victor Hugo imagined a peaceful ‘United States of Europe’ inspired by humanistic ideals.

„A day will come when the only battlefield will be the marketplace for competing ideas.”

This idea became concrete in the destructed Europe after World War 2.



Dresden 1945
25.000 people killed in 3 nights.

Europe after the Second World War:
A Divided Continent.



Sir Winston Churchill
(1874 – 1965)

“Sinews of Peace" address of 5 March 1946, Westminster College in Fulton, Missouri:

“An iron curtain has descended across the Continent.

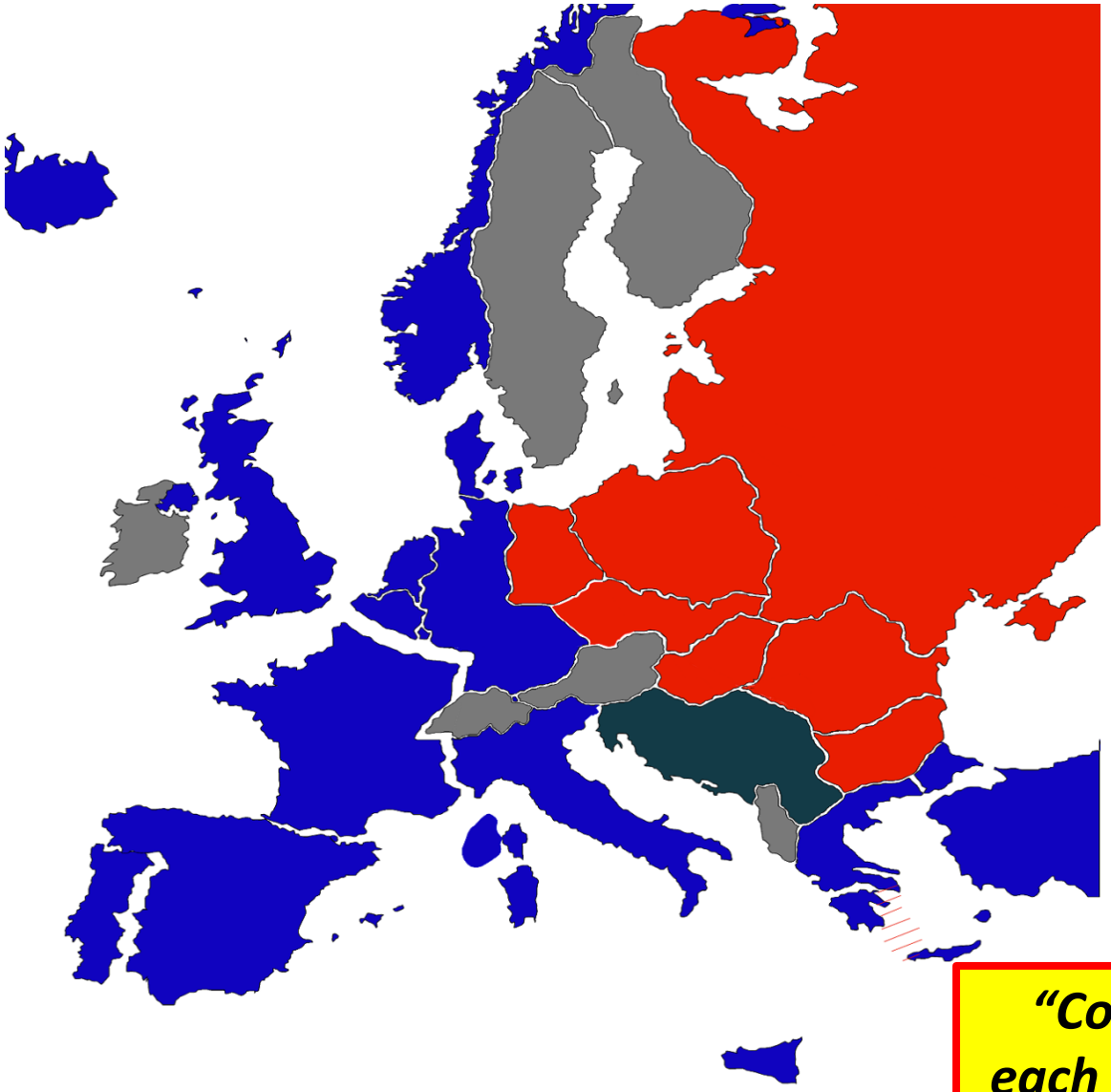
Behind that line lie all the capitals of the ancient states of Central and Eastern Europe.

All these famous cities and the populations around them lie in what I must call the Soviet sphere and are under control from Moscow.”



The Iron Curtain: 4.000km.

Europe after the Second World War:
A Divided Continent – 40 Years of Cold War (1949-1989).



- **Division of Europe:**
  - **Western Europe:**
    NATO members with democratic governments (blue)
  - **Central Eastern Europe:**
    "Warsaw Pact" countries with autocratic communist governments (red)
  - **Militarily neutral countries:**
    CH, AT, ALB, IRL, SE, SF (grey)
  - **Yugoslavia:**
    although communist-run, was independent of the Eastern Bloc (black)

"Cold War" between USA (NATO) and Soviet Union each having thousands of nuclear bombs and missiles.

The Rebuilding of Europe after World War Two.

The USA as the winner of WW2 decided to rebuild Western Europe, established the Marshall Plan in 1948 (15 bio $, worth now 150 bio $) and tied this aid to the goal to create a „European Union“ to avoid future wars.

Between 1945 and 1950, a handful of courageous statesmen set about persuading their peoples to enter a new era.



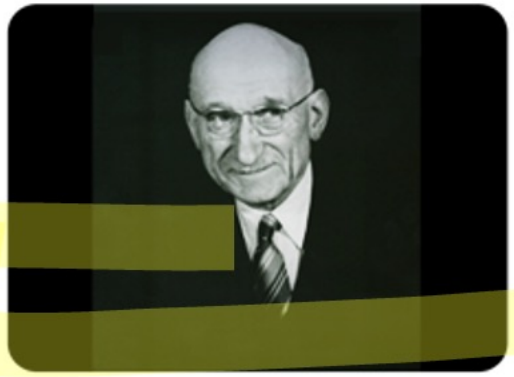
Konrad Adenauer, DE



Winston Churchill, UK



Jean Monnet, FR



Robert Schuman, FR

The „Founding Fathers“ of the European Union.



Alcide de Gasperi, IT

The European Communities.

- **The European Coal and Steel Community (18 April 1951):**
  - Created a common market in coal and steel.
  - Participants BE, DE, FR, IT, NL, LUX.
  - Created a sound basis for the rebuilding of Europe since it provided substantial stimulation for this market.



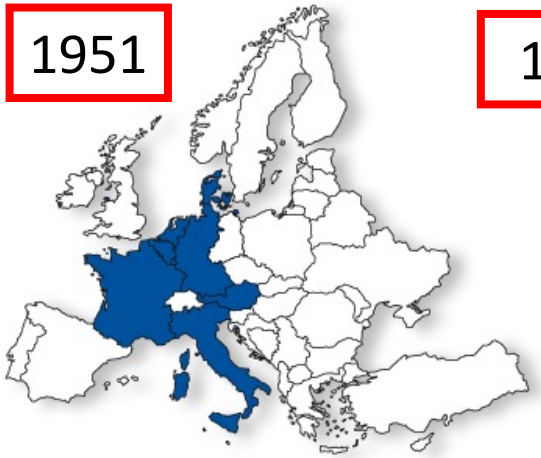


- **Treaties of Rome (25 March 1957):**
- **The European Economic Community (EEC):**
  - Creation of a wider common market covering a whole range of goods and services.
- **The European Atomic Energy Community (Euratom):**
  - Development of peaceful use of nuclear technologies for energy production.

The European Communities 1957 – 2020 (EU-27).

- 1960s with development of common policies, notably on trade and agriculture.
- 1968 abolishment of custom duties.
- From 1973 Enlargements of the Communities.

1951

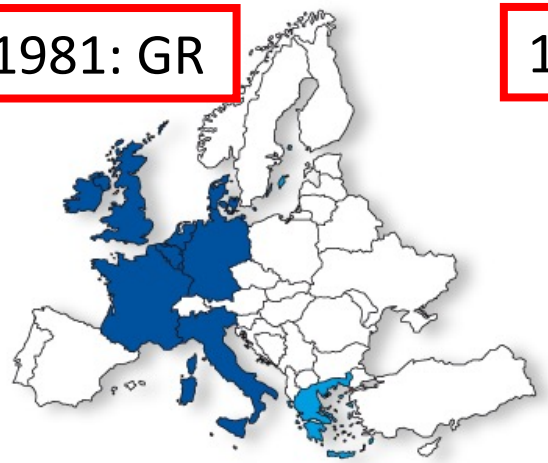


1990

1973: DK, IRL, UK



1981: GR



1986: ES, PO



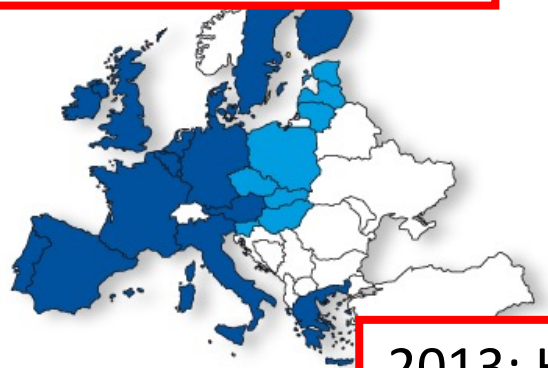
1990: DE United



1995: AT, SE, FI

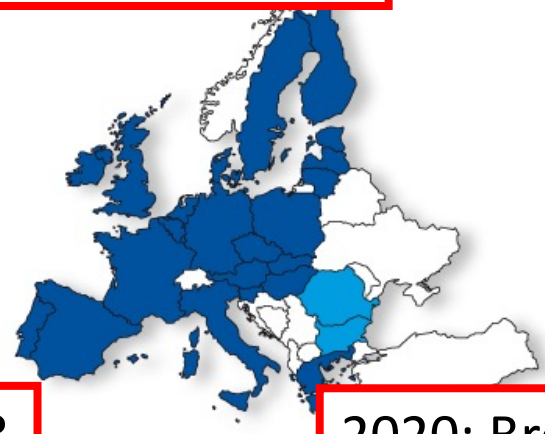


2004: SI, HU, CZ, SK, Pl, LT, LVA, EST, CY, ML



2013: HR

2007: BU, RO



2020: Brexit

Milestones in European Integration.

- **1979 Elected European Parliament:**
  - First elections to the European Parliament by direct universal suffrage.
- **1985 The Schengen Agreement:**
  - Abolishment of Border controls between member states.
- **1986 Single European Act (SEA):**
  - Objective of establishing a single market and codified European Political Cooperation for Security and Foreign Affairs.
- **1993 European Single Market:**
  - Basis for creating a huge free trade zone.
  - Enabled the EU to become one of the three global economic superpowers (alongside the USA and China).
  - The European Single Market is the greatest achievement of the European Communities (European Union).



Simone Veil (FR, SD), First President of EP



Jaques Delors (FR, SD), President EC 1985-1995

The Collapse of the Soviet Union 1989.

Mikhail Sergeyevich Gorbachev:

- General Secretary Communist Party of the Soviet Union 1985 - 1990.
- „Perestroika“ 1986 and „Glasnost“ in 1988 encouraged democratic movements in Central Eastern European Countries
- 1989 fall of the „iron curtain“.
- 1990 Became President of the SU, ended the „Cold War“ with the USA.
- 1991 removed from power by Boris Jelzin.



Mikhail Gorbachev,
1931 - 2022

- Dramatic change of the political landscape of Europe.
- Democratic systems were established in the countries of Central/Eastern Europe.
- Yugoslavia fell apart in a civil war.
- Many of the liberated countries joined NATO and EU.
- Belarus became a close ally of Russia.
- Ukraine independent, but close ties with Russia.



Fall of the Berlin Wall 1989.

Creating the European Union: The Treaty of Maastricht (1991/1993).

- **1991 Treaty on European Union** was adopted by the European Council (in force since 1993).
  - Co-decision right of European Parliament for EU legislation and budget.
  - Adding intergovernmental cooperation to existing integrated Community structures, e.g. in respect to security and foreign policy (Decisions in the European Council).
  - The Treaty of Maastricht created the basis for a further enlargement.





The Copenhagen Criteria for Joining the EU (1993).

- **Criteria for joining the European Union:**

– Stable institutions guaranteeing democracy, the rule of law and human rights.
– Functioning market economy.
– Public administration capable of applying and managing EU laws in practice.

- The EU reserves the right to decide when a candidate country has met these criteria and when the EU is ready to accept the new member.

- **Potential problem:**

– A candidate country fulfills all the accession criteria, but the EU is not „ready“ to include this country! What is the interpretion of „ready“?

- **Acceptance of the ”Acquis Communitaire”:**

– The ”Acquis" includes all the EU's treaties and laws, declarations and resolutions, international agreements on EU affairs and the judgments given by the Court of Justice.
– Thus EU law becomes part of their own national legislation.
– Volume of the „Acquis“: ca 100.000 printed pages.

The Process of Joining the Union.

- Entry negotiations between each candidate country and the European Commission.
- Unanimous decision by the existing member states meeting in the European Council.
- The European Parliament must give its assent through a positive vote by an absolute majority of its members.
- All accession treaties must then be ratified by the member states and the candidate country in accordance with each country's own constitutional procedures.
- This means, that if a referendum must be held in a member state for constitutional reasons (e.g. IRL) or has been set by the government (e.g. AT) the accession of a country could be denied by popular vote (problem case: Turkey).
- During the years of negotiation, candidate countries receive EU aid so as to make it easier for them to catch up economically.
- The whole process normally lasts between 5 and 10 years.
- In difficult situations (like Turkey) applicants may remain in their candidate status for decades.

The European Monetary Union (1999).

- Treaty of Maastricht provided the basis for creating a single currency based on political agreements in the context of German unification.
- Euro was introduced for financial (non-cash) transactions in 1999.
- Introduction of Euro as „real money“: 1 January 2002.
- The Euro is now used by 21 EU Member States and a major world currency for payments and reserves alongside the US dollar.



Basic problem: The basket of the currencies making up the Euro contained more weak (French Franc, Italian Lira, Spanish Peseta, Portuguese Escudo, Greek Drachme…….) than strong currencies (German Mark, Dutch Guilder, Austrian Schilling) leading to massive monetary and economic problems within one decade (see chapter 5.4).

The Evolution of the European Union:
A Series of Treaties.

1952
The European Steel and Coal Community



1958
The treaties of Rome:
The European Economic Community
The European Atomic Energy Community (EURATOM)

2009
Treaty of Lisbon

1987
The European Single Act: the Single Market

2003
Treaty of Nice

1999
Treaty of Amsterdam

1993
Treaty of European Union – Maastricht

The treaties – basis for democratic cooperation built on law. Years refer to enforcement.

The Treaty of Lisbon (2009).

- **Main provisions:**

– A new post of High Representative for the Union in Foreign Affairs and Security Policy to increase the impact, coherence and visibility of the EU's external action.

– Common Foreign Diplomatic Service.

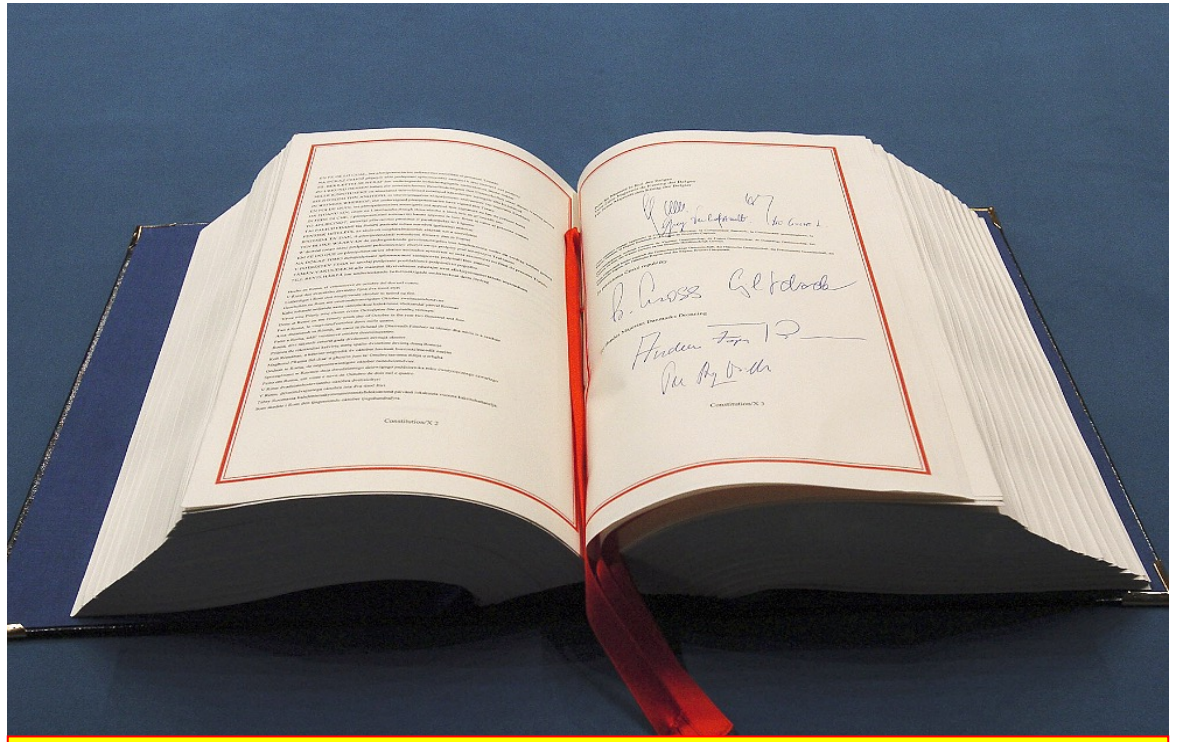
– Election of a president of the European Council for a term of two and a half years, renewable once.

– Inclusion home and justice affairs into the Community domain.

– Creation of the instrument of a European people‘s initiative.

– A legally binding Charter of Fundamental Rights guaranteeing the freedoms and rights of European citizens.

– Possibility of a Member State to leave the Union.



The Treaty of Lisbon of 2007 in 23 languages.

The European Union 2026.

27 Member States
2 Lead languages
(French, English)
24 official languages



- 4,23 million km²
- N to S: 4.000km
- E to W: 3.000km
- 450 million people
- Widely different national histories, cultures and mentalities.

- **7 ecozones:**
  - arctic
  - boreal
  - atlantic
  - continental
  - alpine
  - black sea
  - pannonian
  - mediterranian

Motto: « In Variate Concordia » (United in Diversity)

Source: European Commission, Wikipedia 2019

Special Non-Members.

- European microstates Andorra, Monaco, San Marino, and Vatican City use the Euro and have a close co-operation.
- Iceland, Norway, Switzerland and Liechtenstein:
  - Would fulfill the membership conditions, but public opinion was against joining:
    - Iceland – fishing industry should remain independent
    - Norway – economic autonomy
    - Switzerland – political autonomy
  - Bilateral agreements give these countries nearly full membership status without the right to take part in the decision making process of the European institutions.
- The Agreement with Switzerland is under review due to substantial differences in interpreting the right for the free movement of people.
- The relation with the UK is regulated by the UK-EU Trade and Cooperation Agreement (signed 31 Dec. 2020).

The Mission of the European Union.

Europe's mission in the 21st century is to:

- provide peace, prosperity and stability for its peoples;
- overcome the divisions on the continent;
- ensure that its people can live in safety;
- promote balanced economic and social development;
- uphold the values that Europeans share, such as sustainable development and a sound environment, respect for human rights and the social market economy; and
- **meet the challenges of globalization.**
- **Note:**

– **The EU does not explicitly claim power!**

– **Up to now the European Union was politically very much focused on the interior not on the global situation.**

Source: European Commission

The Values of the European Union.

- **The European Union sees itself as a value based society:**
  - The EU promotes humanitarian and progressive values, also globally.
  - Europeans cherish their rich heritage of values: belief in human rights, social solidarity, free enterprise, a fair distribution of the fruits of economic growth, the right to a protected environment, respect for cultural, linguistic and religious diversity and a harmonious blend of tradition and progress.
- **The Charter of Fundamental Rights of the European Union forms an important policy pillar.**
- **Note: The statement of these values suggest a certain „missionary role“ of the EU within the global community.**
  („Soft Power“ not underpinned by military strength).
- **Nobel Peace Prize awarded in 2012 to the European Union.**
- **Recent developments suggest that the EU should not only be a “Community of Common Values”, but rather a “Community with Common Interests” with means to enforce these interests.**

Source: European Commission

The EU Symbols.



The European flag.



The European anthem.

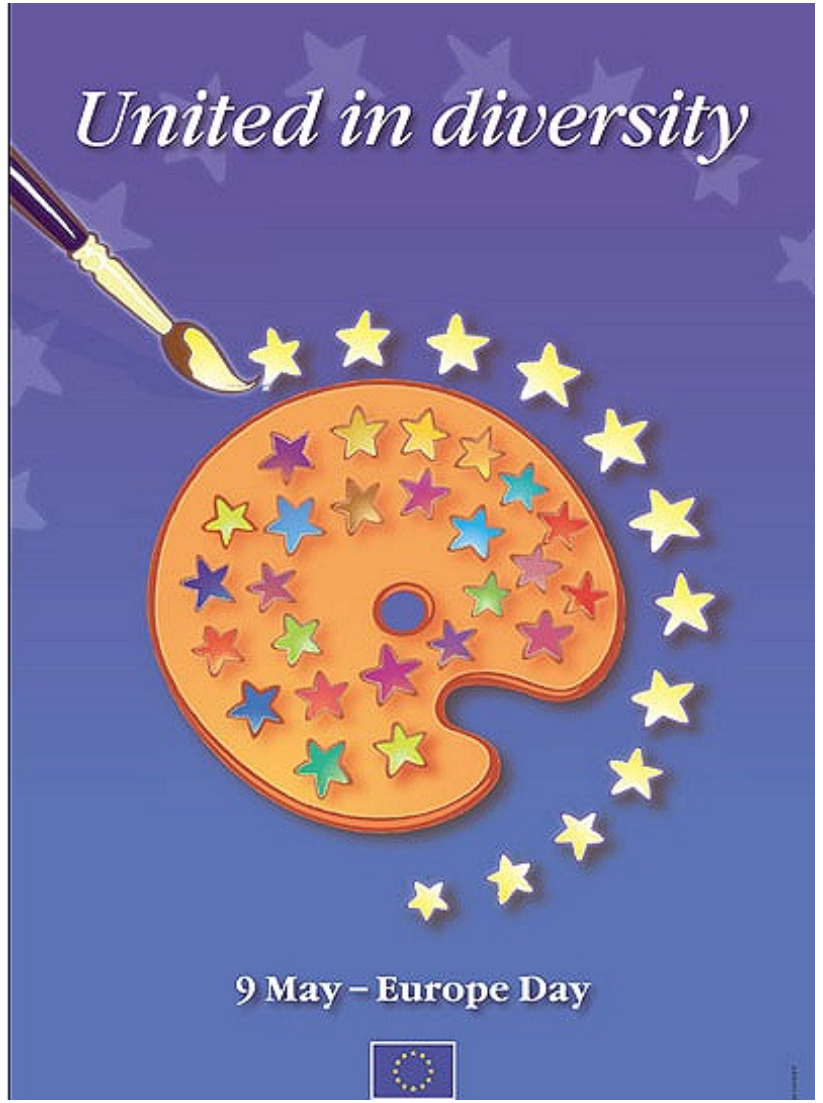


Europe (Schuman) Day, 9 May.



The motto: United in diversity

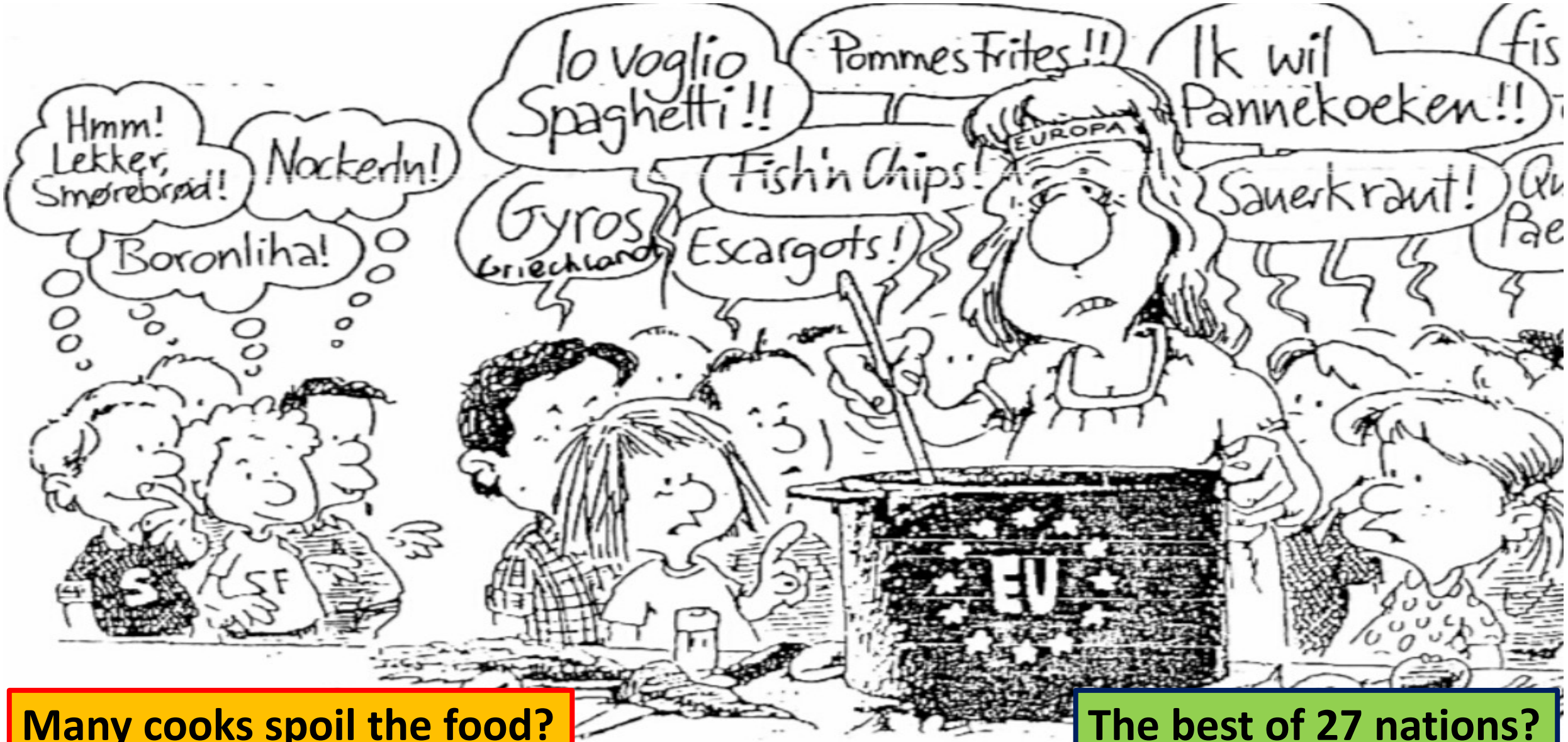
Key Issues for the Future:
Political Integration.



- **How much further political integration ?**
  - ***Integration means transfer of national sovereignty to European institutions.***
- **Towards the United States of Europe ?**
  - **USA:** A federation of states forming a unity (Motto *"E Pluribus Unum").*
  - **European Union:** A unique form of union in which the member states remain independent and sovereign nations while pooling their sovereignty in many areas of common interest *("species sui generis").*
- **The EU is an unfinished project!**

- **The future structure is unclear:**
  - a real Union where all major policies become European, or
  - a lose Federation of Member States where the major decisions are taken at national level („subsidiarity").

United in Diversity:
Strength or weakness?

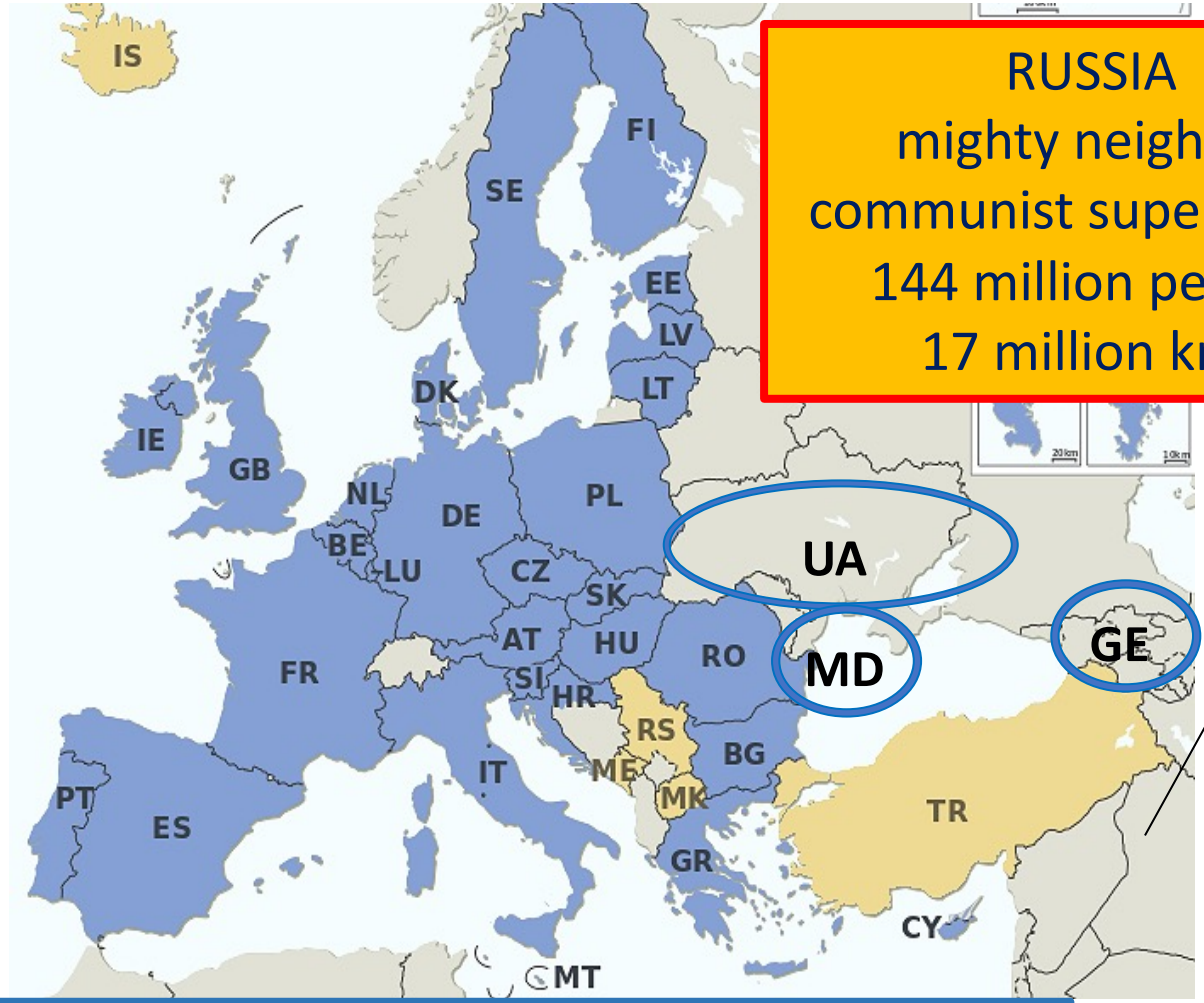


Many cooks spoil the food?

The best of 27 nations?

Key Issues for the Future:
How large should a future European Union be ?

Source: European Commission



RUSSIA
mighty neighbor
communist superpower
144 million people
17 million km²

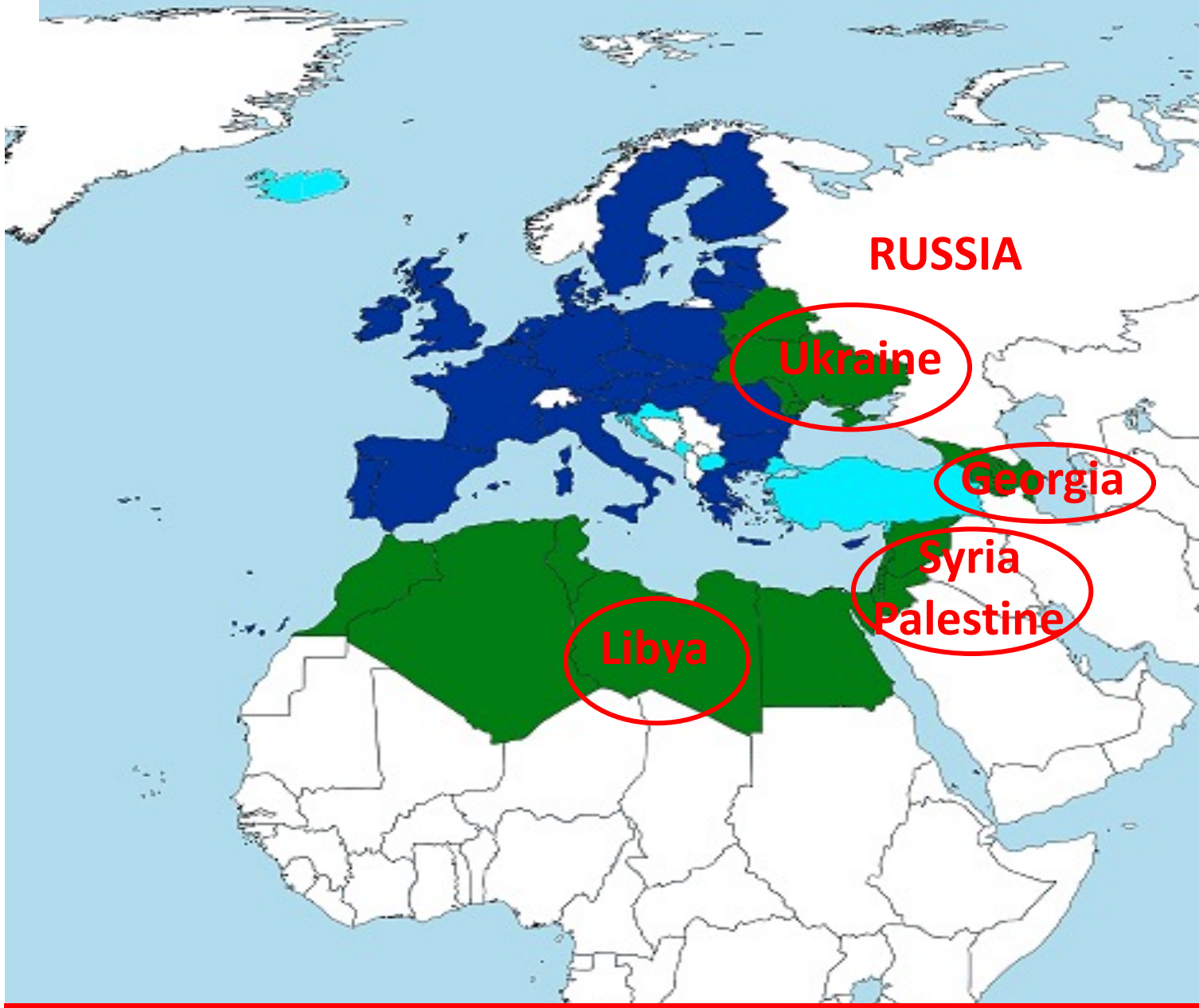
- **Official Candidates for membership:**
  - **Turkey:** 78 million people, 780.000 km², applied for membership in 1987 (!)
  - **Serbia:** 7,1 million people, 88.000 km²
  - **Montenegro**: 0,6 million people, 14.000 km²
  - **North Macedonia:** 2 million people, 25.000 km²
  - **Albania:** 2,8 million people, 29.000 km²

- **Ukraine:** 40 million people, 603.000 km²
- **Moldova:** 2,5 million people, 33.000 km²
- **Georgia:** 3,7 million people, 70.000 km²

Membership not in Russia's interests.

The EU-Neighbourhood Policy.

- **The Western Balkans**
  - Stabilisation and association agreements with Bosnia, Herzegovina and Kosovo.
- **Eastern Europe:**
  - Belarus: now allied with Russia.
- **The Mediterranean Region:**
  - Trade and cooperation agreements with the southern Mediterranean region (“Barcelona Process”).
  - Problematic zone due to civil unrests, wars and massive migration into the EU.
- **The Caucasus Region:**
  - Armenia: close ties with Russia.



Commission President Romano Prodi 2000:
„Ring of Friends“turned into a „Ring of Fire“

A New European Political Community (EPC)?

The issue:

- How to create a structure for an enhanced cooperation between the EU and “friendly” states, esp. candidate countries, avoiding full membership of these countries?
- Initiative of France (2022) to set up an intergovernmental organization (EPC).
- Format: Meeting of Heads of States (similar G7, G20).
- Present participants: 47 states, incl. Great Britain, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland, Georgia, Azerbaijan, Armenia, and all the candidate countries.
- Major areas of enhanced cooperation:
  - Economic and industrial cooperation
  - Military defense (protection from Russia)
  - Energy production and energy security (independence from Russian oil and gas)
  - Cybersecurity – integrated protection against external attacks

Key Issues for the Future:
Russia – an Enemy Forever?

- Partnership and Co-operation Agreement (PCA), in force since 1997.
- EU was largest trading partner of Russia and biggest investor.
  - 37% of Russian imports from EU: 79 billion EUR (2020)
  - 38% of Russian exports into EU: 95 billion EUR (2020)
- Since 2022 massive sanctions against Russia after military invasion into Ukraine: exports and imports drastically reduced.

Nord Stream 1 and 2 pipelines: 1.230km 100 million m^3 gas. Destroyed 2022.

USA was always suspicious of Russian advances towards closer economic and political relations with the EU.

Russia wanted to decrease US influence on EU.



Key Issues for the Future:
The Conflict Russia - Ukraine.

- In the past present Ukraine was split up between Poland, Austria and Russia.
- 1922 the Ukraine became part of the Soviet Union with the status of a Soviet Socialist Republic.
- It became independent in 1991 when the Soviet Union collapsed.
- USA made great efforts to make the Ukraine part of the Western sphere (5 billion $ invested in building advisory structures, direct aid for political parties etc.)
- Elections in the Ukraine resulted alternatively in Russia friendly (Leonid Kravchuk 1991-1994, Leonid Kuchma 1994-2005, Viktor Yanukovych 2010-2014) and West friendly (Viktor Yushchenko 2005-2010) Presidents.
- Serious political conflicts between Russian and the Ukraine started in 2013:
  - Ukraine had the offer to sign an economic cooperation agreement with the Russian dominated Eurasian Economic Union and the European Union.
  - The EU (Merkel/Sarkozy) would not agree that the Ukraine joined both organisations.
  - In this situation the “Russia friendly” Ukrainian President Yanukovych refused to sign the agreement with the EU.
  - Then the “Maidan revolution” broke out and President Yanukovych had to resign.

Key Issues for the Future: The Conflict Russia - Ukraine.

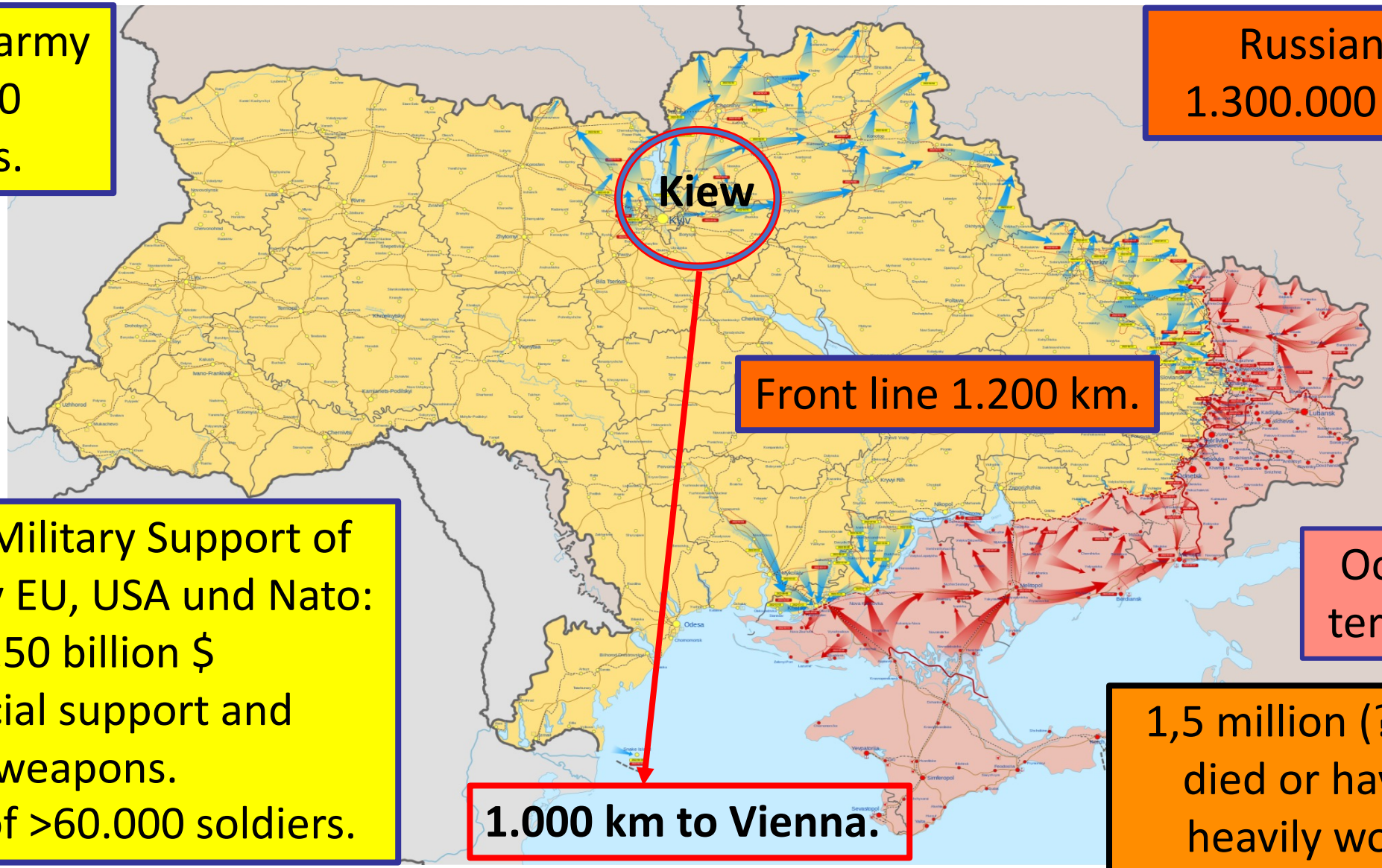
- Consequence: Russia occupied the Crimean peninsula from Ukraine and stimulated internal armed conflicts in the Eastern Ukraine (Donetzk, Luhansk) between Russians and Ukrainians in 2014.
- The West-oriented Pedro Poroschenko was elected President in 2014 followed by Wolodomyr Zelensky (21 April 2019).
- Peace talks between Russia and the Ukraine held in Minsk involving the USA, EU…. led to nowhere: neither side had interest in a pragmatic solution.
- 24 Feb. 2022: Invasion of Russia into the Ukraine and war between these 2 countries with Ukraine receiving steadily increasing support from the NATO-Member States (military equipment in the order of 250 billion EUR, plus training of soldiers) and from the EU providing economic support in the order of 100 billion EUR and temporary accommodation of 6 million refugees (women and children).
- Massive sanctions of EU/USA against Russia with nearly complete isolation of Russia from the “West”, but not from other big economies like China, India, Brazil.
- Good relation EU-Russia completely destroyed for a very long time.
- Peace talks initiated by President Trump in 2025.
- So far neither side seems to have a great interest in ending this war.

The War between Russia and the Ukraine.

Ukraine: 603.00 km^2, 40 million inhabitants (78% Ukrainian, 18% Russian).

Ukrainian army
900.000
soldiers.

Russian army
1.300.000 soldiers.



Massive Military Support of Ukraine by EU, USA und Nato:
>250 billion $
Financial support and weapons.
Training of >60.000 soldiers.

Occupied territories.

1,5 million (?) soldiers died or have been heavily wounded.

The War between Russia and the Ukraine.

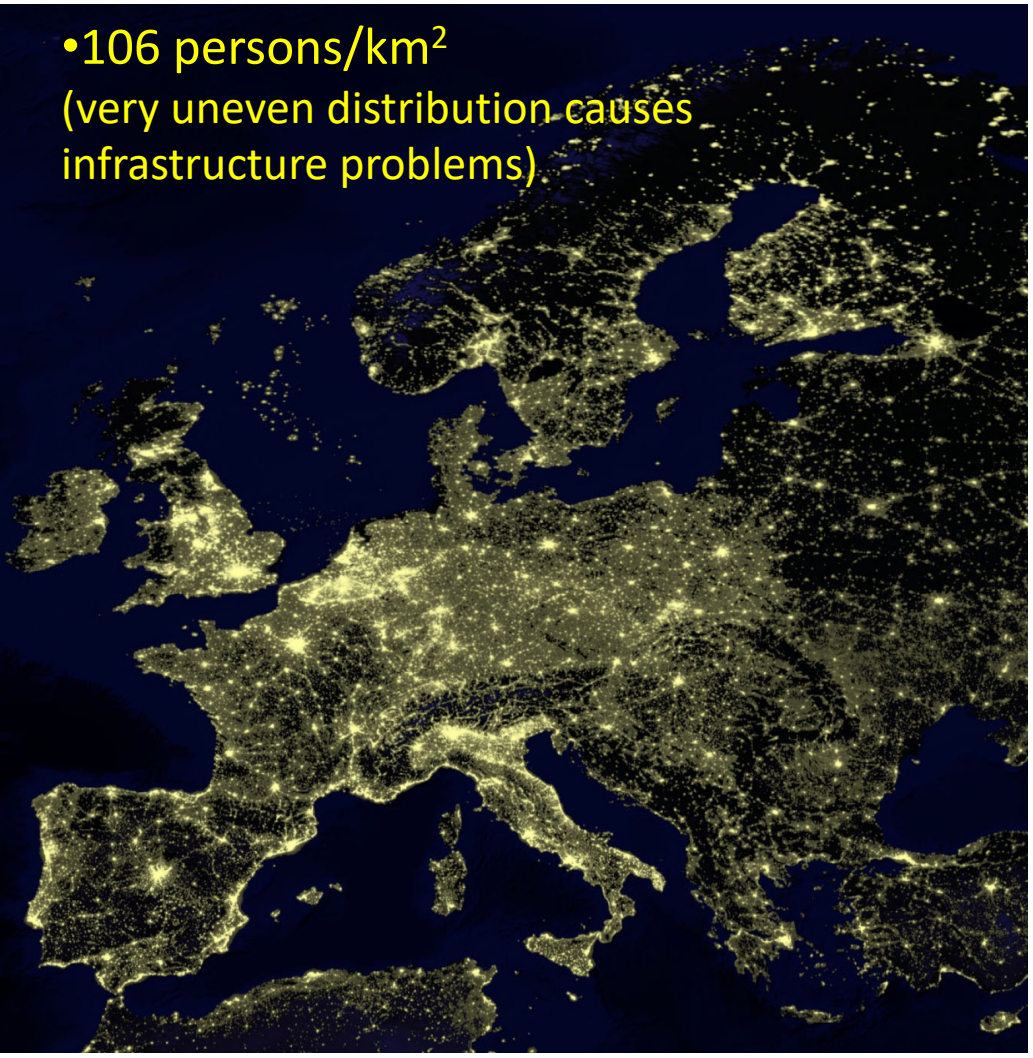
State in 2026: Regular and frequent attacks of Russia on major cities, incl. Kiev and infrastructure with drones and missiles. Eastern Ukraine (Donetzk and Luhansk provinces) devastated. Increasing counter attacks of Ukrainian army on Russia with (intelligent) drones aiming at the destruction of vital military infrastructure (refineries, transport systems). 250.000 buildings destroyed or heavily damaged.





Population and Size of the EU Member States.

450 million people (5,6% of global population), 4.233.000 km² (3,1% of world area).



- DE: 83 million, 357.000 km²
- FR: 64 million, 544.000 km²
- IT: 61 million, 295.000 km²
- ES: 48 million, 506.000 km²
- PL: 38 million, 312.700 km²
- RO: 19.6 million, 230.000 km²
- NL: 18 million, 33.800 km²
- BE: 11,7 million, 30.300 km²
- CZ: 11 million, 77.300 km²
- GR: 10,3 million, 130.700 km²
- PO: 10,2 million, 91.900 km²
- SE: 10 million, 410.300 km²
- HU: 10 million, 93.000 km²
- AT: 9 million, 82.500 km²
- BU: 6,6 million, 111.000 km²
- SK: 5,7 million, 49.000 km²
- FI: 5,5 million, 304.500 km²
- IRL: 5,1 million, 68.400 km²
- HR: 4 million, 56.600 km²
- LIT: 2,7 million, 62.700 km²
- SLO: 2,1 million, 20.100 km²
- LET: 1,8 million, 62.300 km²
- EST: 1,3 million, 43.400 km²
- CY: 0,9 million, 9.300 km²
- LUX: 0,6 million, 2.600 km²
- ML: 0,5 million, 300 km²

Fair balance of influence between large and small Member States?